

Making tools

Early people used stone tools to chop up meat and cut plants and animal skins. The earliest stone tools, called choppers, were simple chunks of glassy rock that were sharp on one side. People made beautifully shaped tools called hand axes. Hand axes could be used for many jobs. They were the Stone Age person's "multi-tool."

Shaping rocks

Flint is a hard rock found in chalk and limestone. The shaping of flint and other stones to make tools is called flintknapping. Stone Age people learned to flintknapp from a young age. It was a skilled technique that took years to master.

Leather clothing helped protect the flintknapper from being cut by sharp pieces of rock flying off at high speed.

The piece of rock being shaped is called the core.

TOOLKIT



Hammer stones

These are rounded rocks used to strike the flint, causing it to split in the direction you want.



Soft hammer

Usually made of antler (deer horn), this causes the flint to break in a thinner, more regular way to make finer tools.

Many of the flakes that come off the rock are still useful as cutting tools because they can be very sharp.